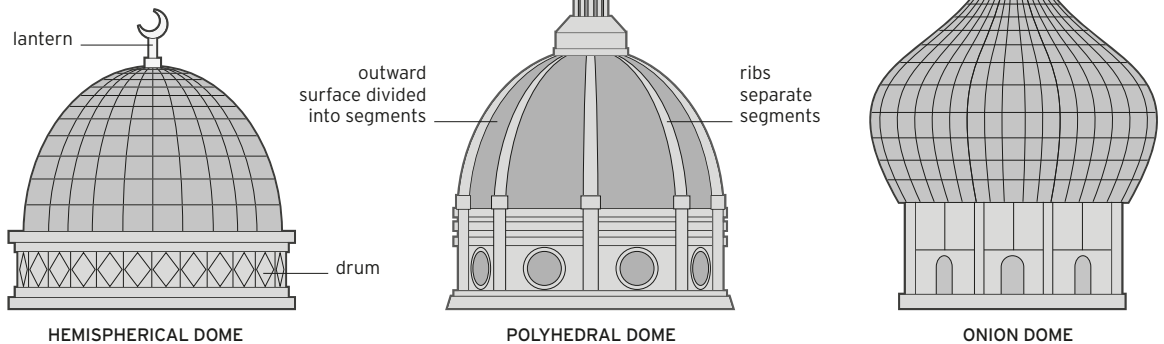


DOME

The dome is a hemispherical structure evolved from the arch, usually forming a roof. It typically sits on supporting walls and is capable of enclosing large internal spaces without the need for any supporting columns or beams.



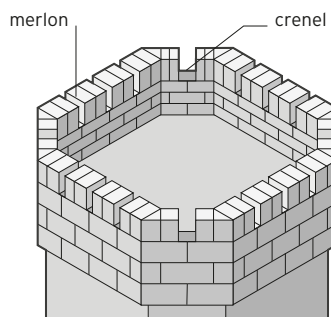
to be embedded deeply into a wall for greater strength and are employed more on external walls, as opposed to brackets, which are often internal.

CORINTHIAN The third of the main Classical orders of architecture. Its main characteristic is an ornate capital carved with acanthus leaves. *See also* acanthus, capital, Classical, Doric, Ionic, order.

CORNICE The horizontal molding that runs along the top of a building.

CORTILE The internal courtyard of a palazzo—often with arcades or colonnades rising many stories—that is open to the sky. *See also* colonnade.

COVING A plain, concave molding used to conceal the joint between a wall and a ceiling.



CRENELLATION ▲ The alternating high parts (merlons) and gaps (crenels) that top a fortified wall.

CROCKETS The small, stylized carvings of buds, curled leaves, or flowers that appear at intervals on spires and finials. They are a particular feature of Gothic churches and cathedrals. *See also* finial, Gothic, spire.

CROSSING The junction where the transepts intersect with the main body in a cruciform church. In a cathedral, the tower often rises above the crossing. *See also* church, cruciform, transept.

CRUCIFORM Having the shape of a cross. Western churches have often employed a cruciform floor plan, in which the main nave is intersected by north and south transepts that form the arms of the cross. *See also* church, nave, transept.

CUPOLA A small dome often used to crown a turret, tower, roof, or larger dome.

CURTAIN WALL A non-load-bearing wall attached to a building's structural frame. Almost any modern building of more than five or six stories will employ a curtain wall. This can be formed of thin slabs of stone, veneer, or metal, but most curtain walls are made of glass set in aluminum frames.

D

DADO The lower part of an internal wall between the skirting board and the dado rail. *See also* chair-rail.

DAIBUTSU Japanese term for a giant Buddha.

DAUB Clay or a similar substance used to coat a surface, especially when mixed with straw and applied to wooden strips (known as laths or wattles) to form a wall, as in wattle-and-daub construction. *See also* wattle.

DECONSTRUCTIVISM A movement in contemporary architecture that seeks to break traditional rules. It questions ideas of harmony, consistency, and symmetry and offers buildings that seem fragmented, unpredictable, and chaotic. A prime example would be Frank Gehry's Guggenheim Museum in Bilbao.

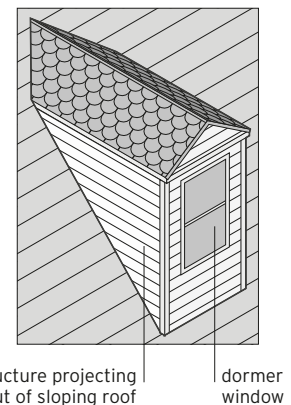
DIOCLETIAN WINDOW A semicircular window divided into three parts by two vertical mullions. It gets its name from windows found in the ancient Baths of Diocletian in Rome. *See also* mullion.

DIPTEROS A building with a double colonnade on all sides. *See also* colonnade.

DOME *See* panel, left.

DORIC The earliest of the main Classical orders of architecture. It is characterized by a simple and unadorned capital and a sturdy column. *See also* Corinthian, Ionic, order.

DORMER ▼ An upright window projecting out of a sloping roof. Dormers are often later additions to buildings when an attic is converted into a living space requiring natural light.



DOUBLE-FRAMED ROOF A roof in which extra longitudinal components, known as purlins, run perpendicular to the rafters and join them together, providing additional stability and strength.

DOVETAILING ▼ A type of carpentry joint in which pieces have shaped pins and tails that fit together securely and strongly without nails or other fasteners.

